

Cappuccino	@Coffee shop	\$4.50
Dinner	@Pizzeria	\$19.00
Groceries	@Grocery store	\$25.00
Total		\$50.00

On Monday, Adam checked his account online and discovered that he had been charged an extra \$32 for *each* of the things he purchased. Since his paycheck hadn't cleared until that morning, the bank had slapped him with fees of as high as 2,100% on the \$1.50 pack of gum. (And if he weren't able to pay it off right away, it would have been even higher.) The total bill: \$128 in "insufficient funds courtesy fees."

- **Know the different ATM fees your bank charges.** Avoid using ATMs for more than deposits and withdrawals. Some banks actually charge for other transactions like finding out your balance or transferring funds between accounts. Make a habit of handling those transactions online. Or look for a bank with low transaction fees or one that waives all ATM charges when you maintain a certain minimum balance.
- **Limit yourself to four ATM withdrawals per month if possible.** Not only can it be expensive to withdraw, say, \$20 a day from an ATM belonging to a bank other than your own, but it's also a bad way to keep track of where your money goes. Use the worksheet you filled out in Chapter 2 to estimate how much cash you need each week. Then pick one day a week to withdraw cash from the machine—say, every Monday. Make a pact with yourself to make that cash last for the entire week. Promise yourself that once it runs out, you won't get more. This strategy will also help you rein in your spending.
- **Consider "cash back" rather than ATM withdrawal.** You can often make ATM-style cash withdrawals at the supermarket or drug store, though you'll usually be limited